Prepare Your Admission-Day Questions Now, While Nothing Is Urgent

Four prompts to draft the questions you'd ask any new care provider, decide how the family will stay in touch, mark what can't be filled in yet, and keep a template ready.

Where you are

Dad doesn't need a new care arrangement, and this isn't about choosing one. You've watched a friend go through an admission day in a blur and would rather know what to ask before you're standing in a hallway with a clipboard.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You have a short, reusable set of questions and a family communication plan, with clear blanks for the contacts and schedules that only a real provider can supply.

A one-page first-days template: Questions for any provider before arrival, Contact fields to fill in later, Family update plan, and Not known until a provider is chosen.

Before you start

- Anything you've heard from friends about what admission day was like for them.
- A list of who in the family would want to be kept informed.
- A sense of Dad's routines and the things he'd want nearby. None of this needs to be complete.

PROMPT 1

Draft the questions you'd ask any provider

WHY THIS MATTERS

On the day, people hand you forms and you sign them. The questions come to you that night. Writing them down now, with no pressure, means you'll have them when it counts.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Whatever you've heard from others about admission day, and what worries you about it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My father does not need a care change right now, but I want to be ready to ask good questions if a care provider ever starts, at home or in a community. Here is what I have heard from others and what worries me about that day:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Write a list of questions a family could ask any provider before the first day, in four groups: WHAT TO BRING, WHO WE WILL DEAL WITH, HOW THE FIRST DAYS WORK, and HOW CONCERNS ARE HANDLED. Keep each question short enough to ask out loud. Do not recommend a kind of provider or setting, and do not answer the questions; they are for a provider we have not chosen.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Questions you'd be embarrassed to forget on the day.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Cross out any you already know the answer to and keep the rest.

PROMPT 2

Mark what changes from one provider to the next

WHY THIS MATTERS

A friend's experience with one agency is not a map for another. Some things are the same everywhere. Many are not, and a template that pretends otherwise will mislead you.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The question list from the first prompt.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are my admission-day questions:
>
> [PASTE THE LIST FROM PROMPT 1]
>
> Beside each question, tell me whether the answer is likely to be SAME ANYWHERE (true of most providers) or VARIES BY PROVIDER (depends on who it is, where, and what kind of care). For the VARIES BY PROVIDER questions, add a blank line labeled 'confirm with the actual provider.' Then list the kinds of things that commonly differ, such as what paperwork they want, visiting arrangements, how medications are handled on the first day, and who the family's contact is. Do not fill in any answer, and do not describe a specific provider.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How many questions say VARIES. That's why a template needs blanks, not answers.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the blanks blank. Note on the page that they wait for a real provider.

PROMPT 3

Decide how the family will stay in touch

WHY THIS MATTERS

When something finally happens, the person on the spot gets fifteen texts asking the same thing. A plan made now, when nobody is upset, saves that.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Who in the family would want updates, where they are, and how they like to hear things.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> If my father ever starts with a new care provider, these are the family members who would want updates, where they live, and how they prefer to hear things:
>
> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Draft a simple family update plan with these headings: WHO COORDINATES UPDATES (suggest one person and a backup from my list, as a proposal), HOW OFTEN IN THE FIRST WEEK, WHAT CHANNEL, WHO IS AUTHORIZED TO SPEAK WITH THE PROVIDER (leave this for us to decide, just list the question), and WHERE CONCERNS GET COLLECTED. Then write three short questions I can ask the family so we agree on this before anything happens. Do not assume anyone has agreed to a role.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A single place where concerns would land, instead of a group text.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Raise the three questions at the next family gathering and write down who agreed to what.

PROMPT 4

Put the template together

WHY THIS MATTERS

A template is only useful if you can find it and trust it. One page, clearly labeled as unfinished on purpose, does the job.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I have drafted for a future admission day for my father, which is not scheduled and may never happen:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Lay it out on one page with four headings: QUESTIONS FOR ANY PROVIDER BEFORE ARRIVAL, CONTACT FIELDS TO FILL IN LATER, FAMILY UPDATE PLAN, and NOT KNOWN UNTIL A PROVIDER IS CHOSEN. Show the contact fields as empty labeled lines. Add a top line that says the template is to be reviewed and updated before it is used. Do not fill in any blanks or add anything I didn't give you.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page with more blanks than answers. That's correct for this stage.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

File it with Dad's other care information. The next step below gives it a center to attach to.

Start with what a provider would ask you.

On an admission day, the provider asks about Dad. The care interview gathers that into one Family Care Profile now, so the answers are ready and current whenever a template like this gets used.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›